Joaquim Meira

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Education

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA
Ph.D. in Political Science — 2028 (expected)
- Fields: Comparative Politics; Political Methodology

M.A. in Political Science — 2024

Fundação Getulio Vargas (FGV), Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
M.Sc. in Public Administration — 2020
- Field: Institutions, Policy, and Government

Universidade Federal de Pernambuco (UFPE), Recife, Brazil
B.A. in Political Science — 2018

Publications

Tapped on the Shoulder: How Executives Influence Electoral Careers in Presidentialism (with Timothy J. Power and Cesar Zucco; forthcoming at *Comparative Political Studies*)

Working Papers

Digital Party-Building (Dissertation project)

The Rise and Fall of the Party for Rent: State Parties and Individual Careers in Brazil

Substantive Cues of Candidates' Class: Insights from Brazil
(with Jorge Fernandes, Mafalda Pratas, and Alon Yakter)

It's Raining Cats and Dogs: The Animal Rights Agenda in Brazil
(with Lucas Gelape)

Teaching

Lead Instructor

GOV 97 - Parties and Campaigns in the Digital Age (Harvard)	S2026

Teaching Fellow/Teaching Assistant

GOV 1146 - Electoral Politics in the Developing World (Feyaad Allie, Harvard)	F2025
GOV 1290 - Democracy and Authoritarianism (Steven Levitsky, Harvard)	S2025
GOV 20 - Foundations of Comparative Politics (Steven Levitsky, Harvard)	F2024
Statistics 1B - Causal Inference (Cesar Zucco, FGV)	2020, 2021
Electoral Institutions (Gabriela Tarouco, UFPE)	2018
Microeconomics I (Paulo Melo-Filho, UFPE)	2017
Quantitative Methods II (Dalson Figueiredo, UFPE)	2017

Advising

Honors Theses in Government, Harvard University

Nathalie Milbradt '26. Machine Learning Politics: Large Language Models and Political Opinion Formation in Brazil

João Victor Arruda '25. The Price of Division: The Impact of Political Polarization on Electoral Support for Corrupt Politicians in Brazil (co-advised with Frances Hagopian)

Prizes and Awards

Lee Whittinghill Samuelson Traveling Fellowship	2026
GSAS Summer Predissertation Fellowship	2025
Teaching Certificate, The Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning	2025
Kevin J. Middlebrook Award, Harvard University	2025, 2023
Brazil Research Grant, David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies	2023
Mildred Rendl PhD 1954 Graduate Student Fellowship, Harvard University	2022-23
Master's Scholarship, Brazilian Council for Scientific Development	2019-20
Best Graduate Student Poster Award, ANPOCS	2019
Scientific Initiation Scholarship, UFPE	2016-17

Conference Presentations

2026: European Political Science Society (EPSS), Brazilian Political Science Association (ABCP), Brazilian National Association of Graduate Studies and Research in Social Sciences (ANPOCS)
2024: Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR)
2021: Brazilian Political Science Association (ABCP)
2019: Brazilian National Association of Graduate Studies and Research in Social Sciences (ANPOCS), Italian Political Science Association (SISP)
2017: Latin American Political Science Association (ALACIP)

Departmental Service

Department of Government, Harvard University

Graduate Student Coordinator, Comparative Politics Research Workshop	2024-25
Chair, International Students Committee, Graduate Student Association	2023-25
Co-Coordinator, Graduate Student Poster Session	2024
Co-Coordinator, Graduate Student Political Economy Workshop	2023-24
Mentor, PS-Prep program	2023, 2024, 2025

Other Research Experience

Research Assistant for Frances Hagopian (Harvard)	2022-2025
Research Assistant for Cesar Zucco (FGV)	2019-22
Research Assistant for Natália S. Bueno (Emory University)	2020-22
Research Data Scientist at the Observatory of the Brazilian Legislative Branch, Think tank based in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil	2020-21
Research Assistant for Octavio Amorim Neto (FGV)	2020-21
Research Assistant for Nara Pavão (UFPE)	2018

Affiliations

Weatherhead Center for International Affairs (WCFIA)
Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)
Center for American Political Studies (CAPS)

Software

Proficiency in R, Stata, LaTeX, Qualtrics, SQL

Languages

Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (proficient)

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